DATA PRIVACY BASICS

Cybersecurity Practical Report | Data Classification Table

Student	Nidhi Patil	**Track**	Cyber Security
Tool Used	Google Sheets	**Deliverable**	Data classification table

1. Objective

To identify different types of information and recommend suitable basic protection measures based on the level of confidentiality and the risk if the information is exposed.

2. Procedure

• Opened Google Sheets and created a spreadsheet named *Data Privacy Basics*.

• Prepared a data classification table with data items, examples, classification, exposure risks, and protection measures.

• Reviewed the sample entries and identified suitable controls such as restricted access, masking, encryption, and data minimization.

3. Data Classification Table

Data Item	Example	Classification	Risk if Exposed	Protection Measure
Customer Name	Riya Sharma (synthetic)	Confidential	Identity misuse	Restrict access
Email Address	riya@example.com	Confidential	Phishing attacks	Use access controls
Phone Number	Synthetic sample number	Sensitive	Spam and fraud	Mask phone numbers
Password	DemoPassword123 (demo only)	Sensitive	Account hacking	Store salted password hashes; never store plaintext passwords
Aadhaar Number	Synthetic ID placeholder	Sensitive	Identity theft	Encrypt and restrict access
Company Policy	Internal security policy	Internal	Unauthorized disclosure	Allow authorized employees only
Public Website URL	www.example.com	Public	Low risk; misuse is still possible	Perform regular security checks
Customer Age	22 (sample)	Confidential	Privacy misuse	Collect only when needed
Payment Card Number	Synthetic card placeholder	Sensitive	Financial fraud	Avoid storing; use a compliant payment provider/tokenization
Employee Attendance	Present (sample)	Internal	Employee privacy concerns	Limit access to authorized staff

4. Key Data Protection Principles

• **Access control:** Only authorized people should access confidential or sensitive information.

• **Encryption:** Protect data so unauthorized people cannot easily read it.

• **Data minimization:** Collect and retain only the information needed for a clear purpose.

• **Secure password storage:** Store password hashes using a suitable password-hashing method with salt, never plaintext passwords.

5. Interview Questions and Answers

What is sensitive data?	Information that needs strong protection, such as passwords, identity numbers, and financial details.
Why classify data?	Classification helps an organization apply suitable protection according to the data's sensitivity and risk.
What is data minimization?	Collecting and storing only the data necessary for a specific purpose.

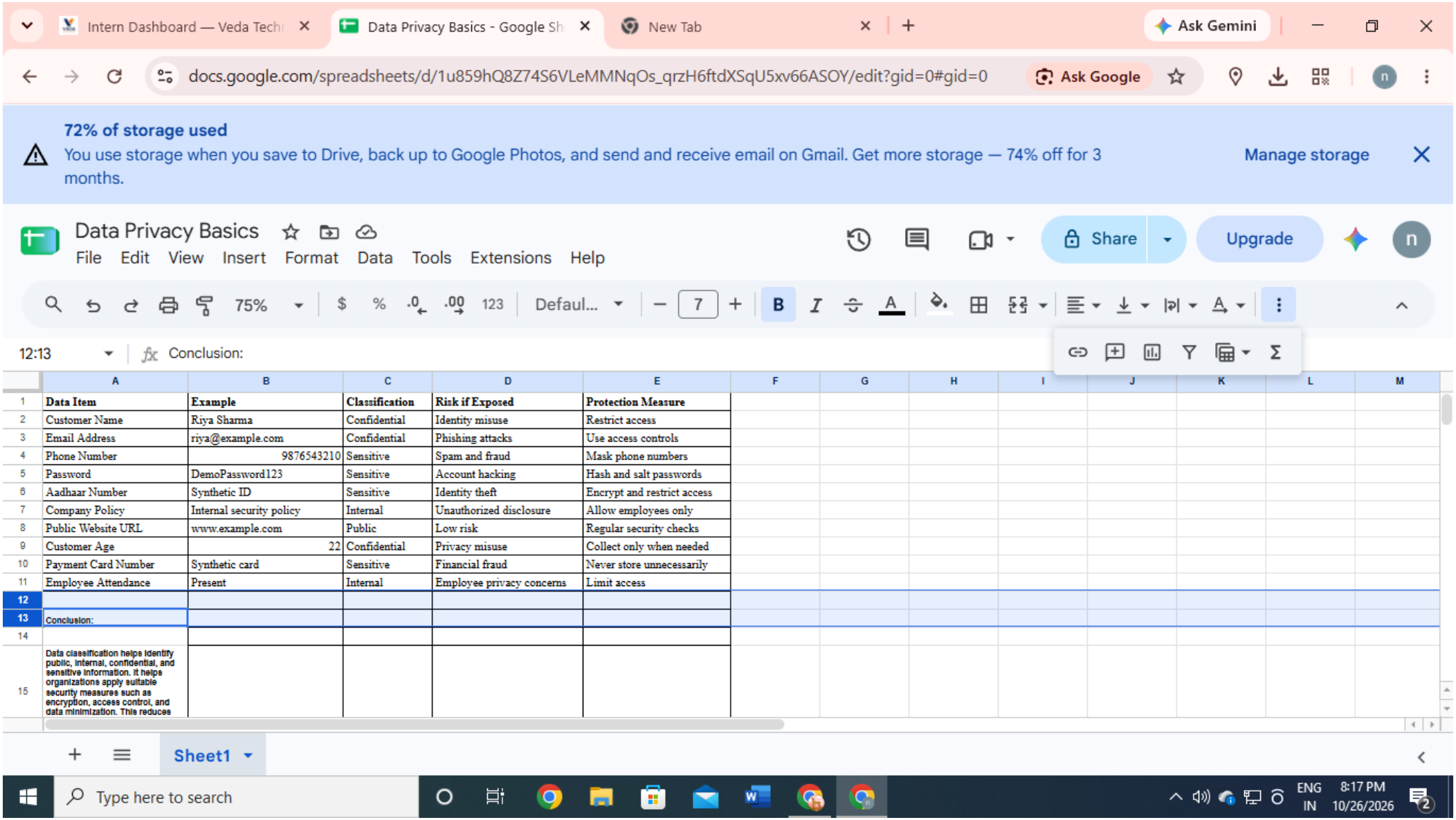
6. Conclusion

Data classification helps identify public, internal, confidential, and sensitive information. It helps organizations apply suitable security measures such as encryption, access control, and data minimization. This reduces the risk of data leakage, identity theft, and unauthorized access.

Note: All examples in this report are illustrative or synthetic. Do not use real passwords, Aadhaar numbers, payment card numbers, or personal customer data in a training spreadsheet.

Appendix: Google Sheets Practical Screenshot

Evidence of the completed Data Privacy Basics classification table.



Data Item	Example	Classification	Risk if Exposed	Protection Measure
Customer Name	Riya Sharma	Confidential	Identity misuse	Restrict access
Email Address	riya@example.com	Confidential	Phishing attacks	Use access controls
Phone Number	9876543210	Sensitive	Spam and fraud	Mask phone numbers
Password	DemoPassword123	Sensitive	Account hacking	Hash and salt passwords
Aadhaar Number	Synthetic ID	Sensitive	Identity theft	Encrypt and restrict access
Company Policy	Internal security policy	Internal	Unauthorized disclosure	Allow employees only
Public Website URL	www.example.com	Public	Low risk	Regular security checks
Customer Age	22	Confidential	Privacy misuse	Collect only when needed
Payment Card Number	Synthetic card	Sensitive	Financial fraud	Never store unnecessarily
Employee Attendance	Present	Internal	Employee privacy concerns	Limit access
Conclusion:				
Data classification helps identify public, internal, confidential, and sensitive information. It helps organizations apply suitable security measures such as encryption, access control, and data minimization. This reduces				